

Phishing campaign - GoPhish

I. Executive Summary

A simulated phishing campaign was executed in a controlled VM environment using the open-source GoPhish framework to evaluate user susceptibility to a Mulearn-themed credential-harvesting page. Two test recipient addresses (Gmail and Outlook) were targeted. Both messages were delivered successfully and submission of credentials (password) was captured, the Mulearn username was not captured due to form-field configuration.

II. Introduction

Phishing remains one of the most common vectors for account compromise. The goal of this exercise was to simulate a realistic, low-sophistication phishing attempt targeted at Mulearn users to understand how different mail clients respond, what artifacts are captured, and which mitigations would reduce risk. The simulation was conducted in a virtual lab and intended purely for educational and defensive testing purposes. All testing was performed on accounts owned by the tester and within an isolated environment.

III. Methodology

- Environment: Kali Linux VM running GoPhish.
- Sender Profile: Created a sender profile using a personal email (for testing only).
- Email Template: Built an email derived from a real Mulearn OTP notification; modified copy to create a sense of urgency requesting the recipient re-verify their login.
- Landing Page: Created a Mulearn-lookalike landing page that mimicked the Mulearn login UI, configured to capture submitted form data (capture password enabled). Also added a redirect to the real Mulearn login page so victims would land on the legitimate site after submission.
- User List: Added two test addresses (Gmail and Outlook).
- Campaign Launch: Launched the campaign and monitored GoPhish dashboard for delivery, opens, clicks, and submissions.
- Validation: Opened emails in client UIs (Gmail web and Outlook web) and followed the link to observe warnings, rendering, and credential capture behaviour.
- Documentation: Collected screenshots at each step.

IV. Findings

I first loaded up the GoPhish in my kali linux and logged into the gophish admin account. I then started editing the sender profile as shown in the following image.

Edit Sending Profile

Name:

Interface Type:

SMTP

SMTP From: ?

Host:

Username:

Password:

☒ Ignore Certificate Errors ?

Email Headers:

Show entries Search:

Header	Value
No data available in table	

Showing 0 to 0 of 0 entries

For the landing page I created similar mulearn login page and checked the capture submitted data and capture password, then also added a redirect link to the actual mulearn login page app.mulearn.org/login.

Edit Landing Page

Name:

[Import Site](#)

HTML

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Hello ! Welcome back

Enter your muid or email address to request for OTP

☒ Capture Submitted Data [?](#)

☒ Capture Passwords

Warning: Credentials are currently **not encrypted**. This means that captured passwords are stored in the database as cleartext. Be careful with this!

Redirect to: [?](#)

Cancel

Save Page

Then I created an email template from an actual email I got from mulearn regarding an OTP. I modified the mail to look like an urgent login verification is necessary for the mulearn account.

Edit Template

Name:

mulearn

Import Email

Envelope Sender: ?

nandu682015@gmail.com

Subject:

Verify your account

Text

HTML

<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
 <head>
 <meta
 name="__cloudhq_email_draft_json"

content="eyJjb3VudGVycyI6eyJ1X3JvdyI6MTAsInVfY29sdWl1IjoxNiwidV9jb250ZW50X3RleHQiojEwLzIxMnNvbmlbnRfaWlhZ2UiOjUsInVfY29udGVudF9idXR0b24iOiIsInVfY29udGVudF9zb2NpYWwiOiQEsInVfY29udGVudF92awRlbyI6MSwidV9jb250ZW50X2h0bwWiOjcSInVfY29udGVudF9oZWFKaw5nIjoxfSwiYm9keSI6eSJpZCI6InFvdVVYeWFUdGciLCJyb3dzIjpibeyJpZCI6ImVRZb2tmdzgiLCJjZWxscGFkaCk6emBvcTkuKubUBtbheMiOlEtITmkLTicimNSNKOUUYomZCPSTcTeMphbeDlhaDg-TieheyJeZCI6IlZed"

Add Tracking Image

+ Add Files

Show 10 entries Search:

Name

No data available in table

I then edited the users and groups by adding my 2 temporary emails of gmail and outlook.

Edit Group

×

Name:

mulearn

+ Bulk Import Users

Download CSV Template

First Name

Last Name

Email

Position

+ Add

Show

10

 entries

Search:

First Name

Last Name

Email

Position

test	nandakumar	test1.nandaku...	
test1	nandakumar	test1.nandaku...	

Showing 1 to 2 of 2 entries

Previous

1

Next

Close

Save changes

I then started a campaign with these options we created.

New Campaign ×

Name:

Email Template:

Landing Page:

URL: ?

Launch Date

Send Emails By (Optional) ?

Sending Profile:

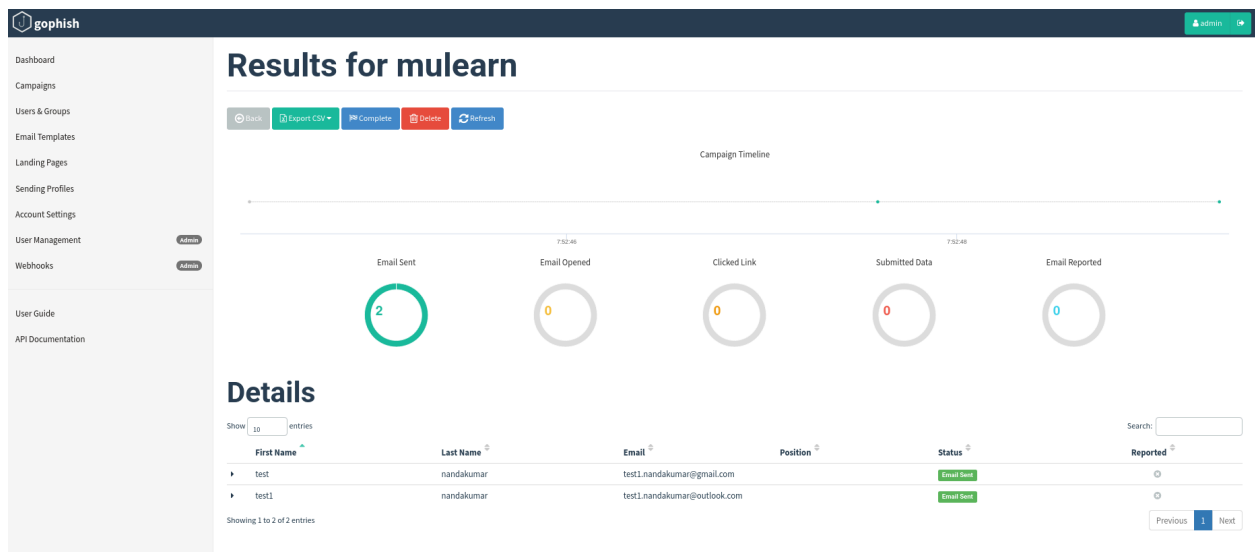
▼✉ Send Test Email

Groups:

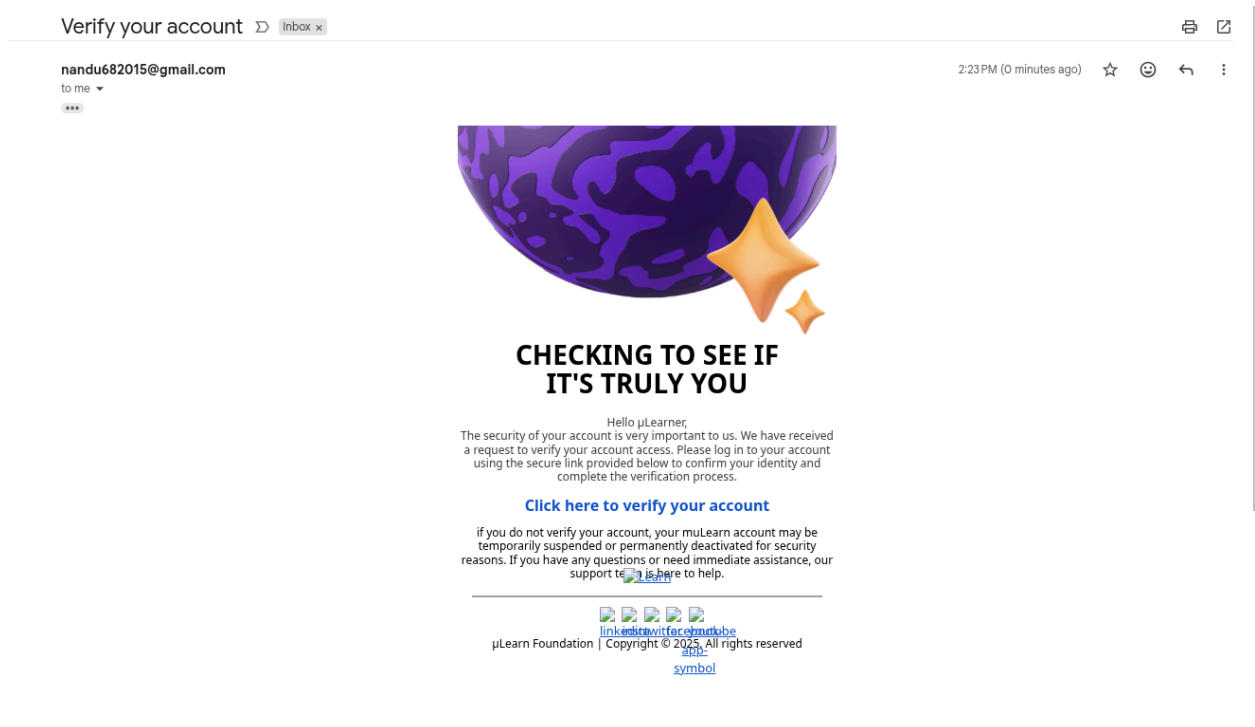
× mulearn

Close🚀 Launch Campaign

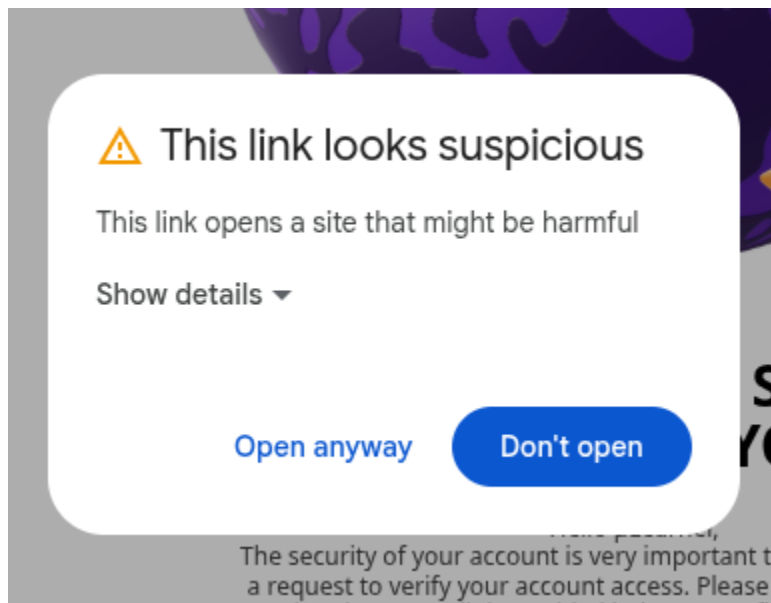
Both of the email was send successfully.



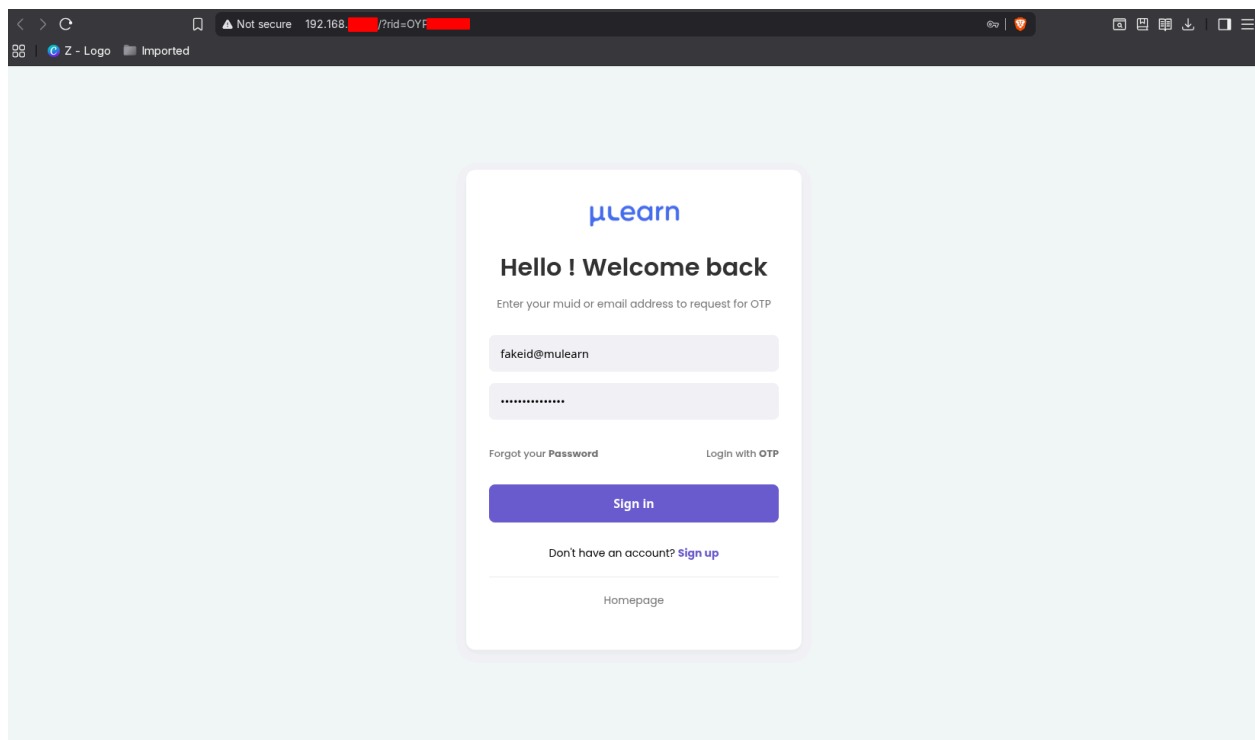
In gmail while reviewing the mail i think i should've formatted the mail. At the end of the mail there are images which didn't render and some hyperlink text overlaid on each other. I should've removed unnecessary images and hyperlinks (but the best solution is to format it).



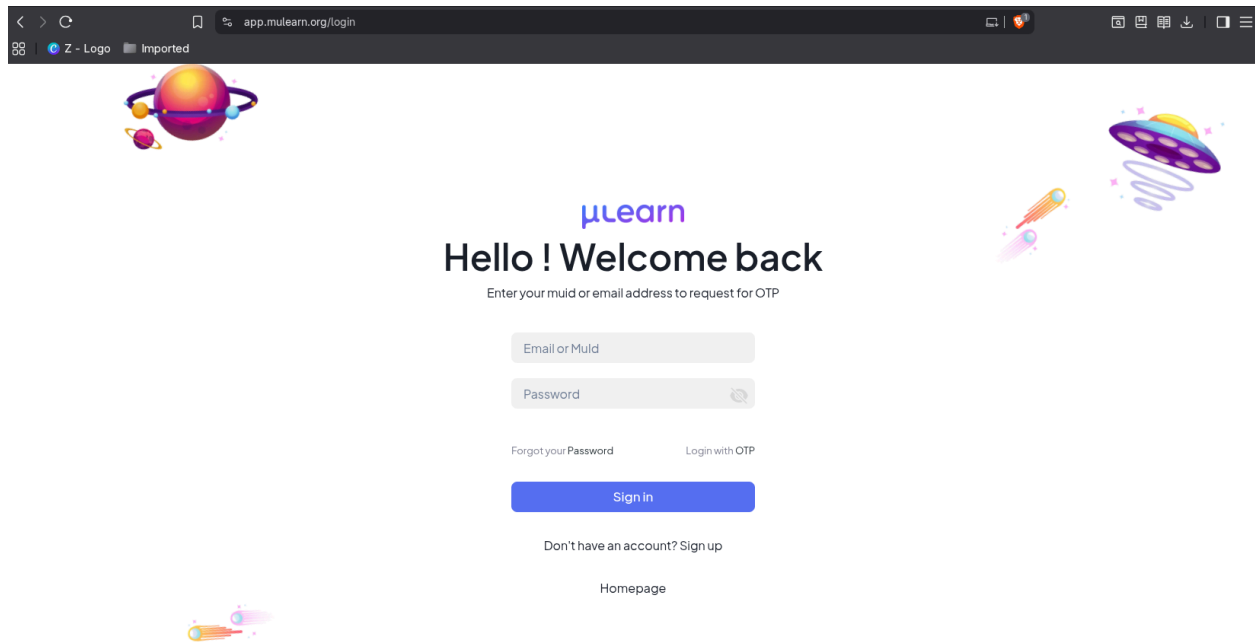
While opening the link in gmail, google immediately warns us with a popup stating the link might be harmful.



After continuing to the link we will end up in the landing page where the fake mulearn login page is shown.



And after we enter the username and password it will redirect to the actual mulearn login screen.



In outlook while reviewing the mail all of the assets rendered successfully but at the bottom the mulearn logo overlapped over some text. I should've formatted it better.

N nandu682015@gmail.com ← ↩ → 📧 ⋮
To: You Thu 10/30/2025 2:23 PM



CHECKING TO SEE IF IT'S TRULY YOU

Hello μ Learner,
The security of your account is very important to us. We have received a request to verify your account access. Please log in to your account using the secure link provided below to confirm your identity and complete the verification process.

[Click here to verify your account](#)

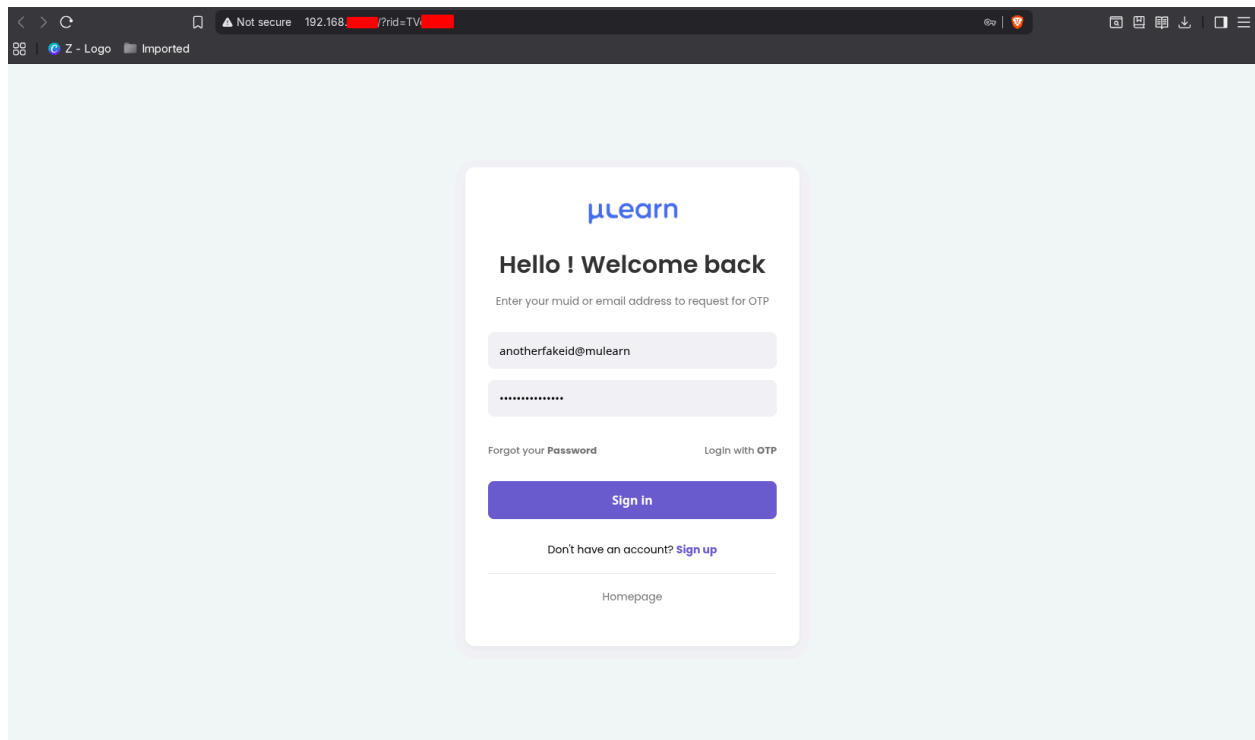
if you do not verify your account, your μ Learn account may be temporarily suspended or permanently deactivated for security reasons. If you have any questions or need immediate assistance, our support team is here to help.



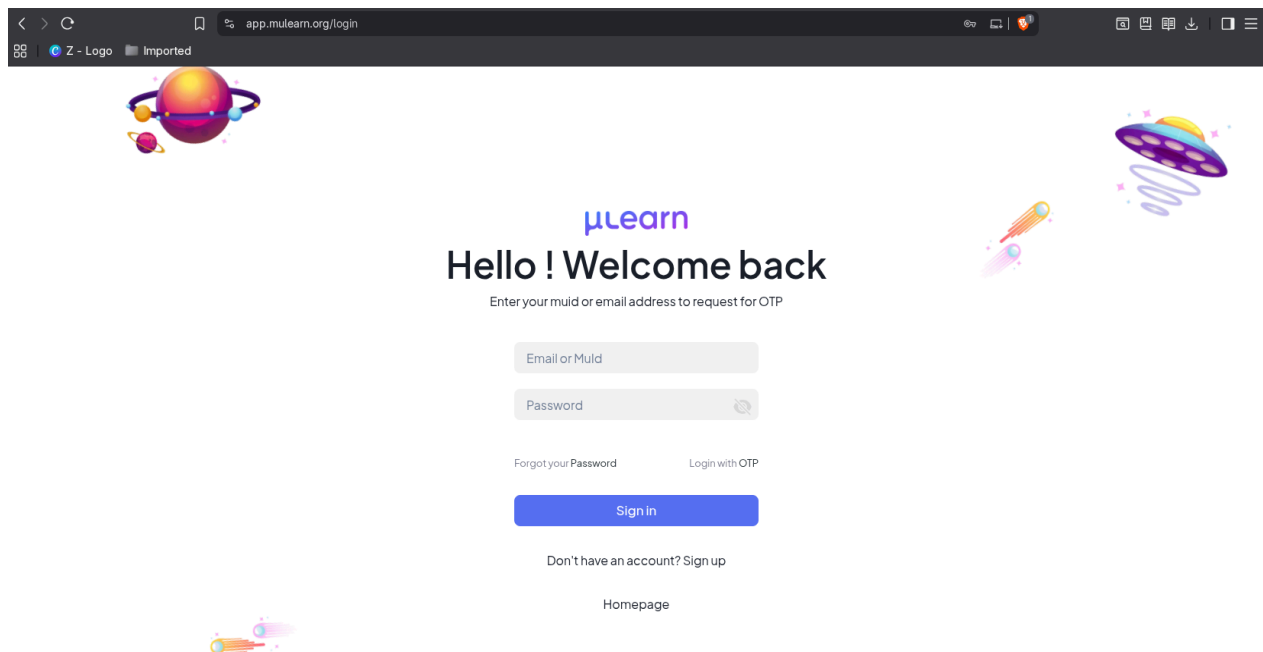
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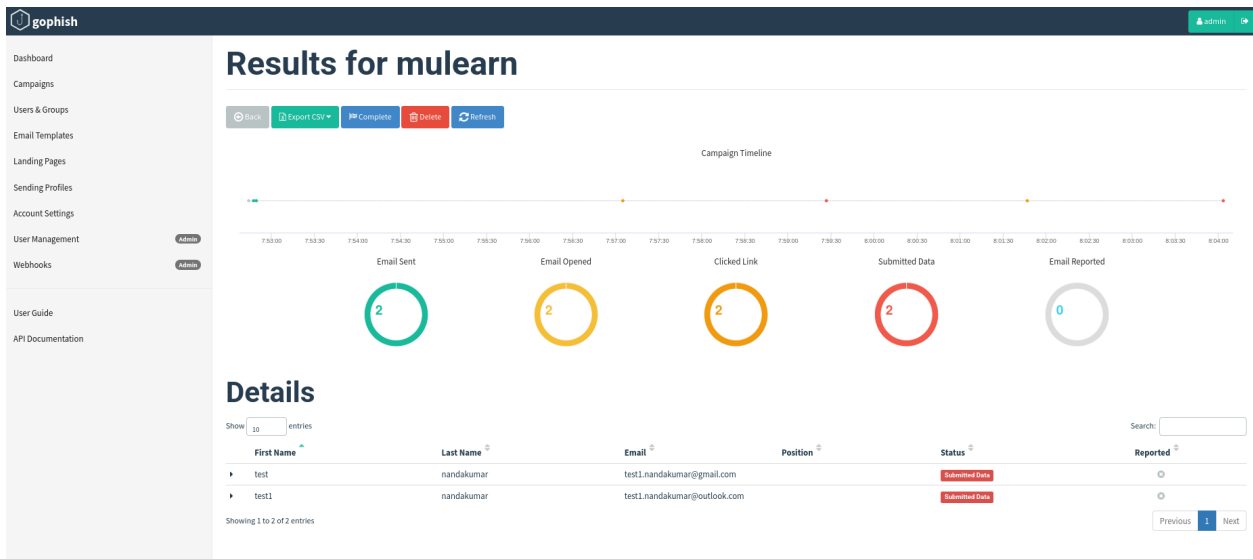
The landing page works the same as what we've got in via gmail, we will end up on the landing page where the fake mulearn login page is shown. But the best thing was on outlook there were no popup showing the link might be harmful (where as in gmail there was one).



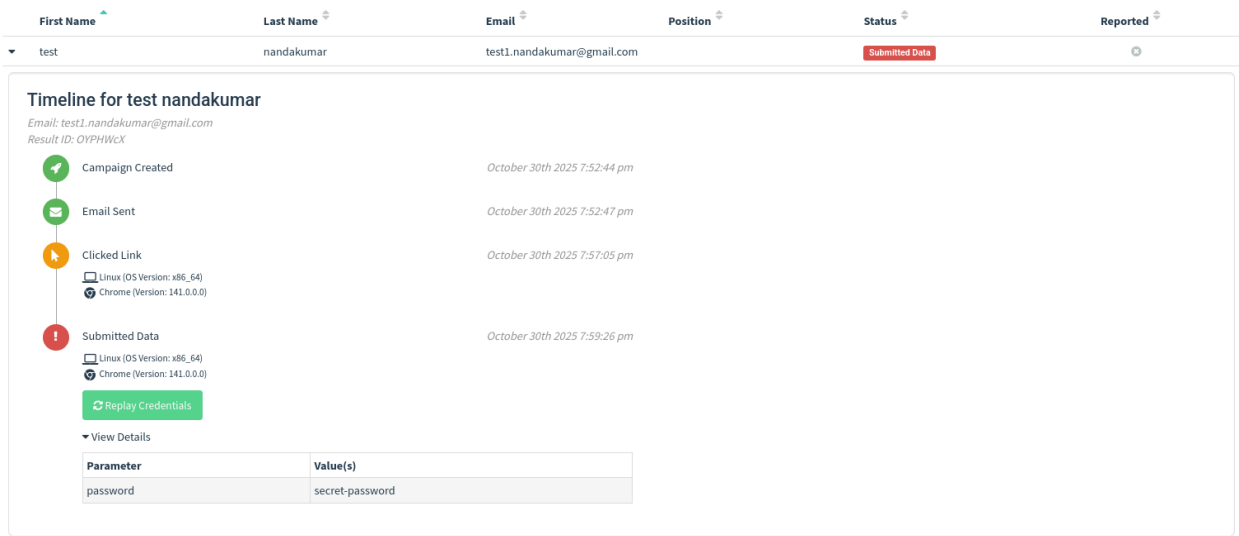
It then redirected to the real mulearn login



The results of the phishing campaign was shown in the gophish dashboard.



The detailed results are as follows:
gmail:



outlook:

test1

nandakumar

test1.nandakumar@outlook.com

Submitted Data

Timeline for test1 nandakumar

Email: test1.nandakumar@outlook.com

Result ID: TVqKDay

 Campaign Created

October 30th 2025 7:52:44 pm

 Email Sent

October 30th 2025 7:52:49 pm

 Clicked Link

 Linux (OS Version: x86_64)

 Chrome (Version: 141.0.0.0)

October 30th 2025 8:01:47 pm

 Submitted Data

 Linux (OS Version: x86_64)

 Chrome (Version: 141.0.0.0)

October 30th 2025 8:04:03 pm

Replay Credentials

View Details

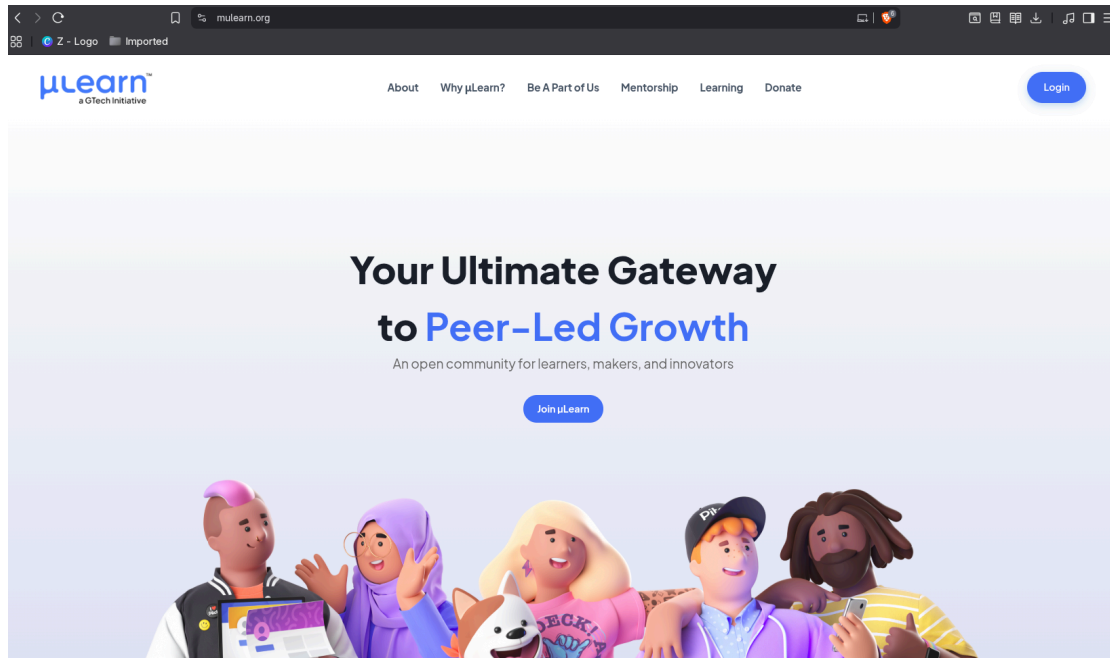
Parameter	Value(s)
password	secure-password

Another thing i found in my phishing campaign was i was able to get the password but i didnt get the mulearn id, i guess by modifying the landing page config i might get the mulearn id as well.

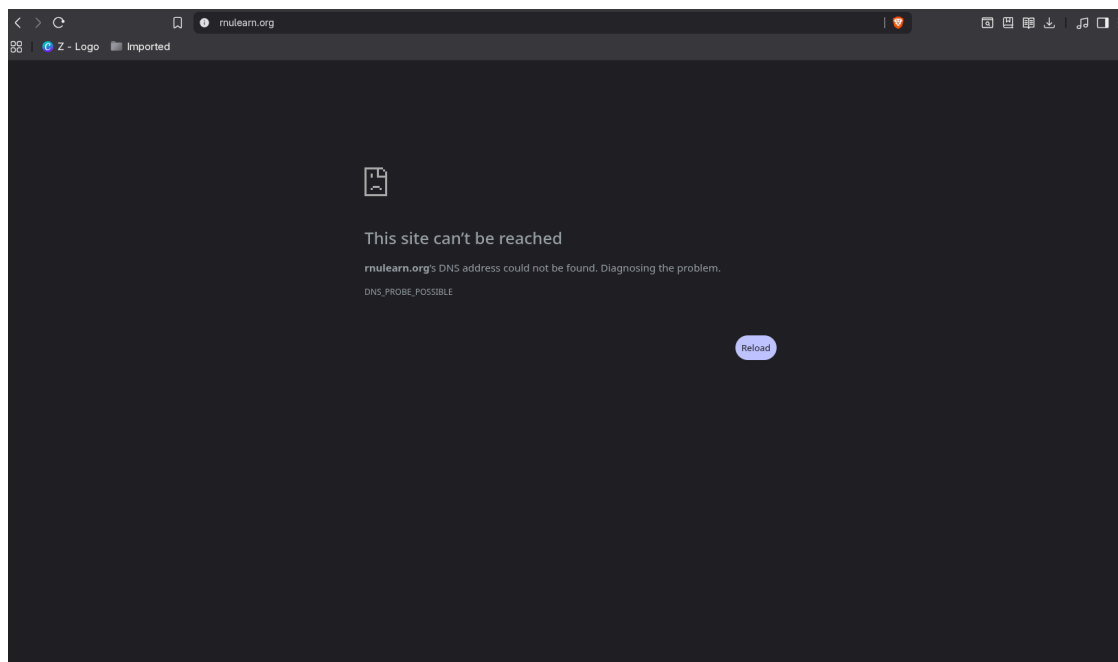
V. Further Findings/ Research

Right now the email is sent via my own email, but in this specific campaign we could buy an actual domain similar to mulearn.org. For example if we replace M in mulearn with small RN then we'll get rnulearn.org. Following is the screenshots for reference

mulearn.org



rnulearn.org



Here while looking at the domain name it gets too easy to miss. And the other thing is the domain is up for sale.

The rnulearn.org can be bought for 1 rupees for the first year. So basically this is a low level threat via phishing

EXACT MATCH

rnulearn.org ⓘ

SAVE 100%

ⓘ Best value for 3 year term

₹ 1.00/1st yr ~~₹ 1,299.00~~

Make it yours

✓ .org domains are the choice of non-profits and communities worldwide.

✓ This domain is suitable for educational resources and online learning. ⓘ

VI. Solution/ Recommendations

The easiest solution will be buying the rnulearn.org domain while it is available. Or the more time-consuming and lengthy option would be to educate the users about phishing.

VII. Conclusion

The simulated campaign successfully demonstrated how relatively low-effort phishing attempts (using a convincing email and a lookalike landing page) can capture credentials and bypass user suspicion, especially if clients do not surface warnings. Although Gmail presented a warning in this test, it alone is not sufficient — users who proceed past warnings or clients that do not warn will remain vulnerable. A layered defensive posture is necessary to reduce the risk. The exercise also underscores the value of regular, authorized phishing simulations to measure real user susceptibility and to refine organizational defenses.

VIII. Contact Information

For any further information or clarification regarding these findings, please contact:

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Mulearn: nandakumark.s@mulearn

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